

Muhammad Danish

Albuquerque, NM | mdanish@unm.edu | (505) 219-6410 | mdanish.net

Education

University of New Mexico

- Ph.D. in Computer Science
- M.S. in Computer Science
- B.S. in Computer Science; Minor in Honors Interdisciplinary Liberal Arts

Albuquerque, NM

Aug 2025 – May 2028

Aug 2025 – Jul 2026

Aug 2021 – May 2025

Research Publications

1. Danish, M., et al. “**The Tragedy of Convenience: Cascading User-Data Leakage from SMS-Delivered URLs.**” *ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS)*, 2026.
Led a large-scale study of 33M+ SMS messages and 322K URLs; built an end-to-end LLM-assisted pipeline to identify 170+ PII-exposing services; Performed token-entropy analysis, bounded enumeration, authentication testing, API and WebSocket analysis, and coordinated disclosure with remediations protecting 120M+ users.
2. Sobrados, E., Danish, M., et al. “**Exposing Probe-Resistant VPNs via Protocol Coexistence.**”
Under review at the *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy*, 2027.
Developed an Internet-measurement pipeline that reverse-engineered commercial VPN applications and enumerated 72,887 servers; found that 83.4% were fingerprintable because probe-resistant protocols coexisted with detectable legacy or misconfigured protocols.
3. Danish, M., et al. “**Measuring View-Based Monetization Fraud Across Content-Sharing Platforms.**”
Under review at the *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy*, 2027.
Led a cross-platform study of view inflation across a diverse set of monetizable content-sharing services (e.g., Spotify, Dailymotion, Ameblo); 9 of 10 platforms counted more than 80% of attempted views and attacks on five platforms persisted & scaled using consumer-grade infrastructure;
4. Acharya, B., Danish, M., et al. “**Surveyception: An Exploration of Deceptive Survey Forms.**”
Under review at the *Privacy Enhancing Technologies Symposium (PETS)*, 2027.
Developed an LLM-assisted classification, automated engagement, and graph-analysis pipeline for 140K forms from 10 providers; identified 2,645 forms soliciting sensitive information, 566 scam forms, 3,200+ associated scam accounts, and 300+ coordinated campaigns.
5. Danish, M., et al. “**Security and Robustness Trade-offs in Compressed Deep Learning Models.**” In Progress.
Developing a cross-task evaluation framework to quantify how different compression techniques (e.g., quantization, pruning, knowledge distillation) affect robustness and security under rare or adversarial conditions.

Experience

- **Research Assistant (PI and Reference: [Afsah Anwar](#)), University of New Mexico** Dec 2023 – Present
 - Conducted large-scale AI, security & privacy research, resulting in multiple publications.
 - Built end-to-end pipelines and reverse-engineered AI/web/mobile systems to uncover vulnerabilities.
 - Characterized security & privacy issues in multiple systems (e.g., web, AI/ML) and proposed mitigation strategies.
- **Student Programming Analyst, University of New Mexico** Oct 2022 – Aug 2025
 - Automated cross-department administrative workflows using Microsoft Power Platform, Power Automate, and Boomi.
 - Built regression-test suites and integrated them into Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines, reducing testing time by ~50%.
 - Delivered web applications and system integrations across multiple departments, supporting 20,000+ students.
- **Computer Science Teaching Assistant, University of New Mexico**
 - Led weekly programming, networking, and security labs for 40+ students.
 - Developed exercises, graded assignments and examinations, and provided individualized technical feedback.
 - Fostered a collaborative learning environment via group discussions, one-on-one sessions, and [YouTube](#).
 - **Courses:** Introduction to Cybersecurity, Computer Networks, and Intro/Intermediate Programming

Awards & Skills

- **Awards:** [CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher](#) (North America), NMEF Scholar (New Mexico), [Bug Bounty](#)
- **Languages:** Python (PyTorch and TensorFlow), Bash, PowerShell, Java, JavaScript, SQL, MATLAB
- **Technical:** model compression, adversarial ML, LLMs, agentic AI, web & API security, reverse engineering
- **Tools:** Linux/Windows, Playwright, Docker, NMap, Wireshark, Burp Suite, Kibana, Metasploit, Azure, Git

Volunteering

- **Peer Review:** AEC member at top conferences e.g., IEEE S&P ([Award](#)), ACM CCS, NDSS, PETS ([Award](#))
- **Stanford Code in Place (Section Leader):** Mentored diverse students in Python and CS fundamentals.